World

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/93655611.

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
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by linerle

Summary

The world really was just the two of them sometimes.

Written for SPOPtober 2026: Day 2 (Mask)/Day 4 (Destiny).

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

The world really was just the two of them sometimes. Most of the time it wasn't, but when they could decide for themselves, it was.

As far as Catra remembered, she had never been outside the Fright Zone. As far as Adora would admit, she hadn't either. To Catra's recollection they woke up in each other's arms one day, and they were six years old and her back and arms and head hurt from something that had happened to her. Now they were eight. Of course there was life before that one time, or there wouldn't have been any hurting, but why should it matter? All that mattered was Adora, Adora and the day they would be big and strong.

On that sharp and heavy bed in their little quarters, they could pull up the musty covers that smelled of both of them and of tons of dust and just exist. It was always Adora's bed, because Catra's bed was on the other side of the room and Catra's feet never wanted to go there. The light that passed through the blanket was scant but sufficient, because they already knew what they looked like and everything else was so much more interesting. The way Adora made the blanket rustle across Catra's hair when she moved, the way she breathed in with a little squeal whenever they thought someone was coming. The way their hands would always find each other, and the way Adora's heart sometimes became audible in those first moments after they were stuck in and they stopped everything to make sure they'd be alone. The way Adora laughed. The way Catra felt when she could see a faint glitter in Adora's eyes.

One time when the world was just two, Adora said, "I'm gonna kill all the princesses one day."

"Not if I kill them first," said Catra, and grabbed the itchy pillow and shoved it at Adora's face. They both cackled with laughter; everyone else was eating in the cantina, so there was no one around to disturb them. "I'm killier than you!"

"That's not a word!" said Adora. "And I'm killier than you! Shadow Weaver said so!"

Catra stopped laughing. Shadow Weaver said a lot of different things, and half of those things were only for Adora and the other half was only for Catra. There were also other things she only did to Catra. "Shadow Weaver's stupid," said Catra. "And wrong. All the time."

"No, Catra, you don't get it," said Adora, snapping the pillow away and mushing it into Catra's stomach. "She said I can do great things for the world."

"She's stupid! And wrong! And…" here Catra hesitated for a moment, fearing she was moving too close to the truth to bear it. "… and mean," she mumbled.

"You don't get it, Catra!" said Adora, and she was laughing again, and she dropped the pillow and she threw her arms around Catra and the laugh became a warm vibration. "Who cares about Shadow Weaver? I mean I'm going to kill all the evil princesses and you know what happens then?"

Baffled, Catra could only breathe terse against Adora's shoulder.

"Catra!"

"… they'll be dead?"

"No! It means I'll be the ruler of everything. And that means Shadow Weaver can't do nothing to you anymore, 'cos I'll tell her she can't."

Hope dared to rise in Catra's chest, but she tugged it back down. She had no trust that Adora would be given anything if she won: that wasn't how Shadow Weaver and Hordak did things. They would take everything for themselves, like how stupid Octavia won a battle but Hordak announced it like he was the winner. And he said 'we' at the podium, and stupid Octavia was there, but Hordak smiled with the satisfaction of someone who would give

nothing to anyone, because everything and everyone was his. Shadow Weaver was the same, except she didn't even smile about it.

But if Adora actually could…

It was hope again that rushed through Catra's arms as she broke the hug and swept away the blanket. The world was no longer just the two of them, it was also an empty bedroom and a dingy ceiling lamp and a dozen beds that weren't theirs, but Adora was the one who brought up the princesses and that meant the world was already too big. She grabbed Adora by the arms and stared into her twinkling eyes and she said, "Promise. Promise you'll make Shadow Weaver stop."

"I promise!" said Adora, and her smile could fix a hole in the sky. "I'll make it so we both rule everything!" And then she sighed and looked down, and her shoulders fell. "I think it's my destiny," she murmured.

Destiny. It wasn't a word Catra enjoyed. Shadow Weaver had told her that her destiny was to fail; Shadow Weaver had said she was in the way of Adora's destiny. If destiny existed, Catra wanted to scratch its eyes out.

But Adora's eyes were glowing, even when they were looking at the floor. Maybe destiny could be real for a little bit, between the two of them.

"You'd better," said Catra. Adora beamed and flung the blanket over their heads again, and they were everything in the world for a few minutes more — until Lonnie and Rogelio came back from dinner and they had to be quiet. Even so, they were quiet together, interlocked under the same blanket until night claimed them both. The future lay in their dreams, hot and pulsating.

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Seven years later, the dust cleared and the mask was off. Adora stood there glowing white and gold, with a sword that had just cleaved every single tool that Catra had brought to take her back with. And Adora *dared* to look like she was the one who was upset.

Catra said nothing out loud. In her head she said, "I guess a promise doesn't matter to you after all."

She kept the tears in as she turned away to run. But once the dust got so thick that nothing mattered anymore, she cried the heaviest tears that had ever struck her cheeks.

End Notes

hey it's a she-ra fic again. haven't written one of those in two years, but i can promise you'll see at least one from me next year too. and maybe some more this year? (that one's not a promise. i just know i have some ideas)

poor catra. to be so dependent on the one girl in the horde who is too pure-hearted to actually kill any of the princesses

i wrote this for spoptober, but most of my writing this month will be for marigami week! nine fics planned, six of which are already completed, so i can promise at least six and possibly up to nine before the end of the month. so i'll see you for that on the eighteenth if you're a marigami fan, and if you're not and you're just here for she-ra, i'll see you soon-ish! whenever i have a fic ready.

hope you enjoyed reading; leave a comment if you'd like!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!